



HARVESTING AND STORING

Begin to harvest roots when they are about 2 in (5 cm) wide. Spring-sown beets will be ready in summer; summer-sown beets in fall. The longer you leave the roots in the ground, the larger they will become, so thinning them as you harvest will encourage remaining crops to grow bigger. Beets can be overwintered by leaving them in the ground and covering with a 6 in (15 cm) layer of straw. Alternatively, pull up the roots, twist off the leaves, and store in a box of moist sand in a cool, dark place.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Beets are usually relatively trouble-free, but may fall victim to aphids or cutworms. Seedlings may be at risk of damping off; protect against this by maintaining good garden hygiene and giving plants enough light and space.



Beet leaf infested with aphids.